

Hospitality Channel Integration & Onboarding Guide

Guesty | Booking.com | Airbnb | Google Hotel | Xoxoday

Technical writing portfolio sample | August 2026

1. Purpose and audience

This guide explains how hospitality software can connect a property management system or central property platform with major booking channels and other technology partners. It is written for property managers, hotel teams, implementation teams, customer success teams and other users who need to understand the connectivity process without needing to develop the underlying APIs.

What this guide covers

- Guesty, Booking.com, Airbnb and Google Hotel connectivity
- Xoxoday online coupon and digital voucher integration
- Property, room, rate and availability mapping
- Reservation and voucher data flows
- Onboarding, validation, troubleshooting and go-live checks

2. Connectivity in plain language

Connectivity means that two software systems can exchange information through defined interfaces. In hospitality, the connection can allow a PMS or central system to exchange supported information with booking channels. In a rewards use case, an application can connect to a digital rewards provider so users can browse and receive online vouchers.

The important point for an operational user is understanding what information is exchanged, where it originates, what system is expected to receive it and how the result is checked.

3. Systems and their roles

System	Role	Typical information
PMS / property system	Central operational system	Rooms, units, reservations, guests, rates and availability
Connectivity platform	Connects systems and manages supported exchanges	Mappings, connection status, synchronization and errors
Booking channel	Guest-facing distribution channel	Listings, rates, availability and reservations
Google Hotel ecosystem	Hotel discovery and pricing distribution	Hotel content, room information and pricing
Xoxoday	Digital rewards and voucher provider	Voucher catalogue, products, orders and fulfillment status

4. Data that can be synchronized

Hospitality information

- Property information such as name, address, contact details and supported content
- Inventory such as rooms, apartments, units and room types
- Rates and rate plans
- Availability and supported booking restrictions

- Reservations, modifications and cancellations

Digital rewards information

- Voucher catalogue and product information
- Country, currency and denomination information
- Order references and fulfillment status
- Payment or reconciliation information where supported

5. Before connecting a property

- Check that property information is complete and accurate.
- Confirm rooms and units are correctly configured.
- Review rates, rate plans, currency, taxes and availability.
- Confirm that the external channel account or listing is ready.
- Confirm that the authorized user has the required permissions.
- Record the relevant property, room, listing and rate identifiers.
- Use a test or sandbox environment where the provider offers one.
- Define who will monitor the integration after go-live.

6. Onboarding process

A practical onboarding process can be managed in six stages.

- Prepare: validate the source data and integration requirements.
- Authorize: complete the required account connection and permissions.
- Map: match the property, rooms, listings and rates between systems.
- Synchronize: enable the supported information flows.
- Validate: compare the source information with the destination and test representative transactions.
- Go live: activate the production connection and monitor the first transactions.

7. Understanding synchronization

Outbound data normally starts in the property or central system and is passed to a connected channel. Examples include rates, availability and supported property content.

Inbound data can start on a booking channel and be passed back to the property system. Examples include new reservations, reservation changes and cancellations.

Not every field is bidirectional and not every update is instantaneous. The implementation record should state the source of truth, supported direction and expected update behaviour for each important data type.

8. Mapping

Mapping tells the integration which records in two systems represent the same real-world item. For example, a PMS room called One Bedroom Apartment may have a different display name on a booking channel. The mapping connects the two records using the identifiers provided by the systems.

- Validate room and listing mappings before production.
- Validate rate-plan mappings separately where applicable.
- Use stable provider identifiers rather than relying only on display names.
- Keep a record of mappings so support teams can investigate issues quickly.

9. Guesty integration

Guesty can be used as the central property-management environment in a connectivity workflow. For onboarding documentation, the practical focus is on property readiness, account authorization, mapping, supported data synchronization, testing and monitoring.

A production implementation should confirm which property, room, rate and reservation information is supported by the particular connection being used. Current provider documentation should be treated as the source of truth for capabilities and requirements.

10. Booking.com integration

Booking.com provides connectivity APIs for software providers. Current connectivity documentation covers areas including Rates and Availability, Reservations and Room and Rate Plan Management.

For an implementation team, the workflow can be documented as property preparation, connection, room and rate-plan mapping, synchronization, reservation validation and monitoring.

Current Booking.com developer documentation should be used to confirm supported fields, connection types, permissions, certification requirements and changes to the API.

11. Airbnb integration

Airbnb supports software connectivity through eligible property-management and channel-management solutions. A practical onboarding flow is authorization, listing mapping, synchronization and review.

The exact data available through the connection depends on the software provider and current Airbnb requirements. Before go-live, the team should confirm that listing information, pricing, availability and reservation behaviour are displaying as expected.

12. Google Hotel integration

Google Hotel integration was also part of my work. The operational focus was understanding how hotel property, room, pricing and availability information is prepared for distribution through Google's hotel ecosystem and how the integration is checked when information does not appear as expected.

Areas of involvement

- Understanding hotel and room information required for connectivity.
- Coordinating property, inventory and pricing information between the source system and the Google integration.
- Supporting mapping and validation of hotel and room information.
- Working with internal and external stakeholders when information needed investigation.
- Supporting onboarding, testing and operational follow-up for connected properties.

Google's Hotel APIs cover Hotel Prices and Hotel Content. Google also provides a Travel Partner API for managing Hotel Center data for large or complex accounts. The exact implementation depends on the partner setup and products enabled for the property.

Practical workflow

Property setup, hotel and room mapping, content and pricing validation, connectivity setup, testing, issue resolution and production monitoring.

13. Xoxoday online coupon and digital voucher integration

I was involved in the Xoxoday integration work for online coupons and digital vouchers. My involvement was on the business, product, implementation and coordination side of the integration. The work required understanding how the voucher catalogue, product selection, order processing and fulfillment fitted into the application workflow.

Typical user journey

- User opens the online coupon or rewards section.

- The application retrieves the available voucher catalogue and relevant filters.
- The user selects a voucher and denomination.
- The application validates the selection and submits the order.
- The integration receives an order reference and fulfillment information.
- The voucher is made available to the user according to the configured delivery process.
- Operations can use order references for support and reconciliation.

Xoxoday's Rewards API documentation describes REST APIs, OAuth 2.0 and Bearer authentication, voucher catalogue retrieval, balance checks, order placement, order details and payment reporting. The current provider documentation should be used to confirm exact production fields and workflows.

Operational documentation points

- Maintain a clear mapping between the application reward and the provider product ID.
- Record the provider order reference.
- Document how delayed or failed fulfillment is handled.
- Define how duplicate orders are prevented or investigated.
- Keep Finance, Support and Operations requirements in the integration documentation.

14. Troubleshooting

When information does not match, investigate the flow step by step rather than assuming the whole integration has failed.

- Identify the affected property, channel, product or order.
- Identify the affected data, such as rate, availability, mapping, reservation, catalogue or fulfillment.
- Check the connection and authorization status.
- Check the relevant mapping.
- Check the source data.
- Check the provider response or status.
- Record the timestamp, identifiers, expected result and actual result before escalation.

15. Go-live checklist

- Property and source data validated
- Room, listing and rate mappings validated
- Authorization and credentials tested
- Sandbox or test workflow completed where available
- Reservation or voucher order workflow tested
- Negative and exception scenarios reviewed
- Support and escalation process documented
- Monitoring owner assigned
- Customer or operations team trained
- Go-live approval recorded

16. Post-go-live monitoring

- Connection health
- Rate and availability consistency

- Reservation changes and cancellations
- Google Hotel content and pricing discrepancies
- Voucher catalogue freshness
- Voucher order success and fulfillment status
- Repeated synchronization errors
- Payment or order reconciliation where applicable

17. Glossary

Term	Plain-language meaning
API	A defined interface that allows software systems to exchange information.
PMS	Property Management System used to manage property operations.
OTA	Online Travel Agency or booking marketplace.
Mapping	Matching corresponding records between connected systems.
Synchronization	Exchanging supported information so connected systems remain aligned.
Inventory	Rooms, apartments or other units available for sale.
Availability	Inventory available for a particular date or period.
Voucher	A digital reward with a defined value, brand, validity and redemption method.
Catalogue	The list of voucher products available through a rewards provider.
Order reference	An identifier used to trace a transaction through the integration.
Reconciliation	Comparing operational and financial records to identify differences.